

GENESTEALER CULTS

ARMY RULE

Genestealer Cults keep their fighting strength carefully hidden from their oppressors until the glorious Day of Ascension arrives. When they finally emerge to fight, it is after long years of meticulous planning, and with an intimate knowledge of the battlefield that grants them a tactical advantage. Even as battle rages, reinforcements slip from the shadows or spill up from the dark places below, called to war by the Broodmind.

CULT AMBUSH

If your Army Faction is **GENESTEALER CULTS**, each time a unit with this ability is destroyed, roll one D6, adding 3 to the result if it is a **BATTLELINE** unit. On a 4+, that unit is placed into Cult Ambush and you can place one Cult Ambush marker* anywhere on the battlefield that is more than 9" horizontally away from all enemy units (if this is not possible, no marker is placed).

If an enemy model (excluding **AIRCRAFT** models) ends any kind of move within 9" of a Cult Ambush marker you placed, that Cult Ambush marker is removed from the battlefield. At the end of the Reinforcements step of your opponent's next Movement phase, for each of your Cult Ambush markers that is still on the battlefield, you can select one unit from your army that is in Cult Ambush and set that destroyed unit back up on the battlefield using the Deep Strike ability, containing all of its models with their full wounds remaining and with at least one of those models touching that Cult Ambush marker (that Cult Ambush marker is then removed from the battlefield).

CHARACTERS that are attached to a unit with this ability are not returned alongside that unit should it return to the battlefield as described above (only the Bodyguard unit returns).

Designer's Note: *Each time a unit with this ability is destroyed, it triggers all rules that apply when a unit is destroyed. For example, if a rule awards a player 1VP each time an enemy unit is destroyed, and a unit with this ability is destroyed, returned using this ability then subsequently destroyed again, it would award the opponent 2VP.*

* A circular 32mm diameter marker should be used for Cult Ambush Markers.

BROOD BROTHERS

Through cunning and unholy good fortune, a Genestealer Cult can send its questing tendrils writhing into even the highest ranks of the military forces that should be standing guard against it. So does the Patriarch seize new and potent weapons of revolution.

If your Army Faction is **GENESTEALER CULTS**, you can include **ASTRA MILITARUM** units in your army, even though they do not have the **GENESTEALER CULTS** Faction keyword. The combined points cost of **ASTRA MILITARUM** units you can include in your army depends on your battle size, as follows:

- **Incursion:** Up to 250 pts
- **Strike Force:** Up to 500 pts
- **Onslaught:** Up to 750 pts

No **ASTRA MILITARUM** models in your army can be your **WARLORD**, and they cannot be given Enhancements. You cannot include units with any of the following keywords in your army using these rules: **EPIC HERO**; **OGRYN**; **RATLING**; **MILITARUM TEMPESTUS**; **COMMISSAR**; **REGIMENTAL PREACHER**; **REGIMENTAL ENGINEER**; **MUNITORUM SERVITORS**; **AIRCRAFT**.



GENESTEALER CULTS – ASCENSION DAY

DETACHMENT RULE

If your Army Faction is **GENESTEALER CULTS**, you can use this Ascension Day Detachment rule.

THEY CAME FROM BELOW

For generations an insidious threat has lain hidden within the shadows. Now their time is nigh, and from out of the tunnels and sewers they rise to topple their oppressors in brutally violent insurrection. None can escape the sudden ambushes that herald the Day of Ascension!

Each time a **GENESTEALER CULTS** unit from your army is set up on the battlefield as Reinforcements, until the end of your next Fight phase, weapons equipped by models in that unit have the **[SUSTAINED HITS 1]** and **[IGNORES COVER]** abilities.



GENESTEALER CULTS – ASCENSION DAY

STRATAGEMS

If you are using the Ascension Day Detachment rule, you can use these Ascension Day Stratagems.



UNQUESTIONING LOYALTY

ASCENSION DAY – EPIC DEED STRATAGEM

Broodkin are so fanatically loyal that they do not hesitate to sacrifice themselves to protect their leaders.

WHEN: Your opponent's Shooting phase or the Fight phase, just after an enemy unit has selected its targets.

TARGET: One **GENESTEALER CULTS** **CHARACTER** unit from your army that was selected as the target of one or more of that enemy unit's attacks.

EFFECT: Until the end of the phase, each time a **CHARACTER** model in your unit would lose a wound, select one friendly **GENESTEALER CULTS** unit within 3" of it (excluding Vehicle units). Your **CHARACTER** model does not lost that wound and that selected unit suffers one mortal wound instead.

1CP



COORDINATED TRAP

ASCENSION DAY – BATTLE TACTIC STRATAGEM

Flowing like a dark tide down hidden tunnels, along rubble-choked gulleys or through sagging and rusted vents, the faithful utterly encircle their enemies.

WHEN: The start of your Shooting phase or the start of the Fight phase.

TARGET: Two **GENESTEALER CULTS** units from your army that have not been selected to shoot or fight this phase, and one enemy unit.

EFFECT: Until the end of the phase, each time a model in either of your units makes an attack, it can only target that enemy unit (and only if it is an eligible target for that attack), and when resolving that attack, add 1 to the Wound roll.

2CP



GENESTEALER CULTS – ASCENSION DAY

STRATAGEMS

If you are using the Ascension Day Detachment rule, you can use these Ascension Day Stratagems.



TUNNEL CRAWLERS

ASCENSION DAY – STRATEGIC PLOY STRATAGEM

Squirming, crawling and scrabbling through confined spaces is second nature to many broodkin, and is a skill they use to assail seemingly impregnable enemy positions.

WHEN: Your Movement phase.

TARGET: One **GENESTEALER CULTS** unit from your army that is arriving using the Deep Strike ability this phase.

EFFECT: Your unit can be set up anywhere on the battlefield that is more than 3" horizontally away from all enemy models.

RESTRICTIONS: A unit targeted by this Stratagem is not eligible to declare a charge in the same turn.



A PERFECT AMBUSH

ASCENSION DAY – BATTLE TACTIC STRATAGEM

These Cultists have tracked their enemies tirelessly, as predatory beasts stalk their prey. Only when their position is perfect do they strike, engulfing their victims in a hail of unexpected firepower.

WHEN: Your Shooting phase.

TARGET: One **GENESTEALER CULTS** unit from your army that arrived from Reserves this turn and has not been selected to shoot this phase.

EFFECT: Until the end of the phase, improve the Ballistic Skill and Armour Penetration characteristics of ranged weapons equipped by models in your unit by 1.



ONE WITH THE DARKNESS

ASCENSION DAY – STRATEGIC PLOY STRATAGEM

In dark nooks and crevices the true believers of the cult whisper and skulk, all but invisible to those who approach.

WHEN: Your opponent's Shooting phase, just after an enemy unit has selected its targets.

TARGET: One **GENESTEALER CULTS INFANTRY** unit from your army that was selected as the target of one or more of that enemy unit's attacks.

EFFECT: Until the end of the phase, your unit has the Stealth ability and can only be selected as the target of a ranged attack if the attacking model is within 12".



RETURN TO THE SHADOWS

ASCENSION DAY – STRATEGIC PLOY STRATAGEM

Ever cunning and duplicitous, broods of the faithful often vanish back into tunnels and vents after their initial strike, ready to regroup and attack again elsewhere.

WHEN: End of your opponent's turn.

TARGET: Up to two **GENESTEALER CULTS BATTLELINE** units from your army, or one other **GENESTEALER CULTS INFANTRY** unit from your army.

EFFECT: Remove the targeted units from the battlefield and place them into Strategic Reserves.

RESTRICTIONS: The targeted units must have the Deep Strike ability and cannot be within Engagement Range of any enemy units when targeted.



GENESTEALER CULTS – ASCENSION DAY

ENHANCEMENTS

If you are using the Ascension Day Detachment rule, you can use these Ascension Day Enhancements.

PROWLING AGITANT

No matter how often the oppressors seek to trap or silence this leader, they always find themselves left empty-handed and foolish, their elusive quarry long gone.

GENESTEALER CULTS model only. Once per turn, when an enemy unit ends a Normal, Advance or Fall Back move within 9" of the bearer's unit, if the bearer's unit is not within Engagement Range of any enemy units, it can make a Normal move of up to D6".

INSCRUTABLE CUNNING

Every variable has been factored into this strategist's master plan.

GENESTEALER CULTS model only. While the bearer is leading a unit, models in that unit have the Infiltrators ability and each time you select that unit as the target of a Stratagem, roll one D6: on a 4+, you gain 1CP.

METICULOUS PLANNER

No other force spends as long laying meticulous preparations for the battles to come as the Genestealer Cults. Their plans to counter the foe are works of dark genius.

GENESTEALER CULTS model only. Once per battle, just after your opponent uses a Stratagem, if the bearer is on the battlefield, it can use this ability. If it does, until the end of the battle, the CP cost your opponent must pay to use that Stratagem again is increased by 1CP.

FOCUS OF ADORATION

This warlord inspires such insane devotion that their minions will leap headlong into battle in order to win their favour.

GENESTEALER CULTS model only. While the bearer is leading a unit, you can target that unit with the Heroic Intervention Stratagem for OCP, and can do so even if you have already targeted a different unit with that Stratagem this phase.



